

AVELAC

Oral Solution

(Lactulose 667 mg/ml)

What is AVELAC?

Description, Dosage form and Packaging

AVELAC is a clear, viscous liquid, colorless to brownish yellow aqueous solution.

This product is available in pack size of 100ml and 200ml.

What is AVELAC used for?

AVELAC helps in softening the stools and relieves constipation.

Hepatic encephalopathy (HE): treatment and prevention of hepatic coma or precoma.

How AVELAC works?

AVELAC contains lactulose, a laxative that producing bowel movement and softening the stools.

Pharmacodynamics

Lactulose is a synthetic disaccharide osmotic laxative used in the treatment of constipation and in hepatic encephalopathy. Lactulose is broken down by colonic bacteria mainly into lactic acid. This exerts a local osmotic effect in the colon resulting in increased faecal bulk and stimulation of peristalsis. It may take up to 48 hours before an effect is obtained. When larger doses are given for hepatic encephalopathy, the pH in the colon is reduced significantly and the absorption of ammonium ions and other toxic nitrogenous compounds is decreased, leading to a fall in blood-ammonia concentration and an improvement in mental function.

Pharmacokinetics

Taken orally, lactulose passes essentially unchanged into the large intestine where it is metabolized by saccharolytic bacteria with the formation of simple organic acids, mainly lactic acid and small amounts of acetic and formic acids. The small amount of absorbed lactulose is subsequently excreted unchanged in the urine.

How to use AVELAC?

AVELAC is for oral consumption only. Shake well before use.

Constipation

It may take up to 48 hours before an effect is obtained. The dose is gradually adjusted according to response.

Age Group	Starting Dose	Maintenance Dose
Adults	15ml – 45ml	15ml – 30ml
Children (7 - 14 years old)	15ml	10ml – 15ml
Children (1 - 6 years old)	5ml – 10ml	5ml – 10ml
Infant (less than 1 year)	5ml	5ml

Hepatic Encephalopathy

For Adults only.

30ml - 45ml, 3 to 4 times daily. The dose is subsequently adjusted to produce 2 - 3 soft stools daily.

Contraindication

AVELAC does not contain any excipients, but may contain small amounts of related sugars (e.g. lactose, galactose, epilactose, tagatose and fructose).

Do not use AVELAC if you:

- have galactosaemia (genetic disorder where sugar galactose taken is not able to metabolise properly).
- have intestinal obstruction (blockage of bowel).

Precaution

Tell your doctor or pharmacist if you:

- are on a galactose diet
- are lactose intolerance (inability to digest sugar lactose)
- are a diabetic patient
- are pregnant or breast-feeding
- are taking any medications.

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Pregnancy and Lactation

If dietary and lifestyle changes fail to control constipation in pregnancy and lactation, moderate doses of poorly absorbed laxatives may be used. A bulk-forming laxative should be tried first. An osmotic laxative, such as lactulose, can also be used. No effect during pregnancy and lactation are anticipated since the systemic exposure to lactulose is negligible. The use of lactulose may be considered during pregnancy and lactation if necessary.

Interactions with other medicaments

None known.

Does AVELAC have side effects?

May result in abdominal discomfort, flatulence, cramps, nausea and vomiting.

Prolonged use may result in diarrhoea and hypernatraemia (an elevated sodium level in blood).

What to do if you have taken AVELAC more than the recommended dose?

Overdose may lead to diarrhoea with excessive loss of water and electrolytes, particularly potassium. Hypernatraemia has been reported.

How should you keep AVELAC?

Store below 30°C. Keep out of reach of children.

The expiry date of this product is indicated on the packaging.

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Manufacturer

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Product Registration Holder

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